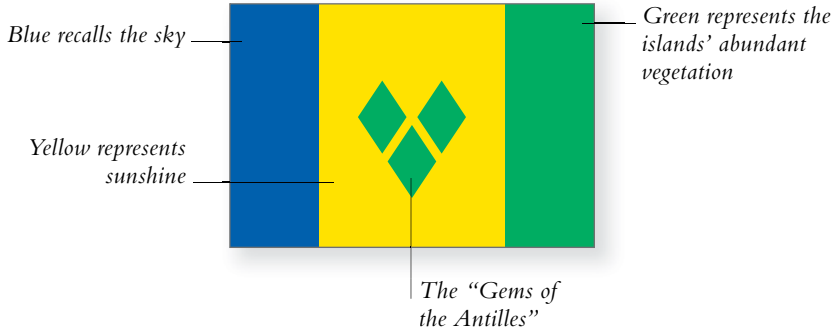


St. Vincent & the Grenadines

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** October 12, 1985 **Usage:** National and Civil



North America



St. Vincent was occupied by the British in 1762. It achieved independence in 1979, together with the **Grenadines**, a chain of adjacent islands.

The basic design and colors of the flag date from the flag hoisted on the day of independence in 1979. It had the arms of the islands placed on a stylized breadfruit leaf in the center. Its blue, yellow, and green stripes were derived from the common colors of the flags assigned to the Associated States by the College of Arms. The breadfruit recalled the British introduction of the breadfruit tree into the Caribbean from the South Seas.

Although this first flag was designed by a local islander, the design did not please all the people of St. Vincent and the Grenadines, and, in 1985, moves were made to secure a new design.

A NEW NATIONAL FLAG

After a local competition failed to produce a satisfactory design, the problem was submitted to a Swiss graphic artist who suggested what is now the current design. In this, the "V" formed by the diamonds stands for St. Vincent, and the diamonds represent its local sobriquet the "Gems of the Antilles."

ARMS OF ST. VINCENT

The coat of arms was first introduced in 1912. It depicts two women, one standing holding an olive branch, the other kneeling to represent peace and justice, which is the national motto—"Pax, Justitia." This appears on a scroll at the base.